

Moonsea Rising - 20240114

Mayhem at Brulehaven

As the party tumbles into the room, the Bruleicos immediately draw their weapons. One immediately runs for reinforcements while the other steps up and attacks Taevyn, hitting him with his polearm. Taevyn sweeps into the room, spinning the guard away from the door so the others can get in. Harken steps back and fires two arrows into the guard. Lennox sprints into the room, swinging his axe. Beitris shields herself and summons her divine weapon, hammering the guard.

Looking around, Lirael decides that it's likely the guard will discover them before they can secure the room, Summoning her magicks, her body shifts and swells into an enormous many-pointed buck. Sprinting swiftly towards the corner of the guard's patrol, she spies the flummoxed man, who stops in his tracks.

In the room, the guard attempts to flee, as Taevyn and Lennox hack at his back. He dives behind some boxes and starts making mechanical noises. The other guard hacks at Lennox twice with his falchion, critically wounding the large man. A third guard draws a massive sword from a weapons rack, and the fourth man, in wizardly robes, casts a ray of frost at Lennox, missing him, and moves to cover along the wall.

Taevyn dances past the standing guard and rips into him with his rapier, goring the man. He dances away from him, and moves to cover the other man by the wall. Harken, meanwhile, races into the room and attempts to push the stack of barrels down on the man hunkering behind them. The man yells out, and a falling clattering sound indicates the barrels and the man are falling down a stair to a lower level. He lies, groaning, on the floor below.

The guard Taevyn is standing next to slashes him with the falchion, but botches his follow-up attacks, allowing Taevyn the opening he needs to knock the weapon from the man's hand. Lennox swings his axe at the guard he's near, hitting him and knocking him to the ground. Lennox strikes him again, and the man drops his weapon, raising his bloodied hands in surrender.

The guard watches the deer suspiciously, as Lirael charges, goring him with her antlers. He slashes wildly at her, but misses in three successive strikes. The guard with the crossbow pops up, hitting Lennox, reloading, and shooting again. The wizard casts a flaming sphere at Taevyn, who dodges away from it. He levels the dark ring at the crossbowman, and a blast of force knocks him back ten feet, dropping the crossbow in the process. Whirl, Taevyn slashes the guard, slaying the man immediately with a delicate thrust of his rapier. Harken continues to push barrels down on the guard whose fallen into the cellar. He's knocked back down the stairs, cursing under the blow. Harken leaps down on the prone man, slashing him with his rapier.

The guard who's surrendered tries to convince the crossbowman that it's time to surrender. He doesn't want to die. The crossbowman calls him a pussy, as Lennox charges him and smashes him with the axe. As he winds up for a second strike, the Bruleico catches the haft of his axe. Looking into Lennox eyes he whispers, "a worthy foe."

Beitris moves into the room, looking around. She redirects her spiritual weapon to the crossbowman, striking him. Outside, Lirael steps back and swings her antlers at the guard, trading misses. The remaining fighting guards attack Harken and Lennox, refusing to stop. The wizard chases Taevyn around with the flaming sphere, though the young man nimbly evades it. He races to the main door, fumbling with the lock.

Taevyn dances after him, but gets tangled in the man's flowing robes. Picking himself up, he dances around the man, slashing at him with the rapier. The attacks feel oddly resisted, but still hit him. Taevyn tells him to surrender and he immediately does, having no stock in dying. In the basement, Harken manages to execute the guard he's been harassing.

Lennox continues to hack at the crossbowman, who doesn't seem interested in surrender, remaining defiant to his last breath. Beitris goes outside, trying to figure out where Lirael is. She redirects her spiritual weapon against the guard Lirael is fighting, smashing him with the ethereal mace. He seems to figure out some things, and reaches for a whistle on his belt. Lirael swipes her antlers at it, but he manages to hang onto it, and turns to flee, blowing it.

Hearing the whistle in the distance, Taevyn demands the wizard tell him where the scions are being kept. He is confused, because they've been searching the city for the scions. Harken looks into the cellar and see that it does have a door that seems to lead to the south. He calls to Lennox to go help Lirael. Beitris gestures for her to come back, but Lirael sprints off to the south at her top speed.

As the party descends into the cellar, and guards mobilize throughout the compound, Lirael, playing the part of wildlife, bounds to the wall, and over it into the city. Dropping into her natural form, she nonchalantly makes her way back around the compound to their point of egress, hiding herself in the copse of trees in case Edric or the others need help escaping.

Cellar Dwellers

In the cellar, the rest of the party picks a locked door and proceeds deeper beneath the compound. Passing through one of the doors, they are sprayed by a fine green mist, which leaves them feeling nauseated and vomiting. Beitris' healers kit and her skill and knowledge help, however, and they're soon reasonably able again. They find a second locked door, which Taevyn manages to open with Harken's assistance. At the third door, they find another trap, which the two manage to disarm. Beyond, they find a dimly-lit hallway with a bunch of barred cells. In one of the cells they find Joshua Brule, who is unaware he's beneath Brulehaven. He doesn't know where any of the other scions are.

Beitris puts him under a zone of truth to stop him and Taevyn from sniping at one another, and tries to understand how he was taken. Josh is convinced that his father couldn't be involved, despite what the others tell him.

At the end of the hallway, a door opens, and a guard walks through. He seems oddly stiff, but then pitches forward, dead. Behind him, a grinning Edric Storm walks into the dungeon. He tells them he has a way out, and to get Josh back to the ship. The party follows him back up through the house, and a trail of dead bodies of servants, guards and many others. Eventually, the tunnels lead

out through the chapel they saw on the way in, proximal, fortunately, to Lirael's hiding place. As she rejoins them, Edric saps Josh to exfiltrate him to the Flame.